

Topic: The Rightly Guided Caliphs

Sub Topic: 1st Caliph: Abu Bakr (RA)

Q (a) Write a detailed account of Main events/Contributions/Achievements of Abu Bakr's (RA) Caliphate. [10]

Structure of Answer

Para 1:

- Morale of Ummah
- Election as Caliph
- Expedition of Usama bin Zaid
- Refusal to Pay Zakat

Para 2:

- Apostasy Movement
- Mischief of False Prophets

Para 3:

- Compilation of Quran
- Expansion of Islamic Empire
- Expeditions in Iraq
- Expeditions in Syria

Answer

- After Prophet's demise in 11AH all companions were shocked and disheartened. They were not ready to believe that Prophet (PBUH) was no more with them. The strongest and wisest of them Hazrat Umar (RA) took his sword and shouted whoever claimed that Prophet (PBUH) has died I will rip his head apart. Hazrat Abu Bakr (RA) controlled the situation by delivering a historical sermon, He stated: "whoever worshiped Muhammad (PBUH) should keep in mind that he is no more with us, and whoever worshiped Allah should keep in mind that he is eternal" and then he recited this verse:
 - ❖ "Muhammad is not but a messenger. [Other] messengers have passed on before him" [3:144]
- Then some hypocrites tried to start a dispute between Emigrants and Helpers on succession of Holy Prophet (PBUH). Helpers gathered at 'Thaqifa Bani Saida' (Assembly of Madinah) and Nominated Saad bin Ibaadah as Caliph. Hazrat Abu Bakr, Umar and Abu Ubaida also reached there and after cross talk all agreed to accept Hazrat Abu Bakr as 1st Caliph of Islam.
- Prophet (PBUH) prepared and sent an army which was led by Usama bin Zaid (RA) to Syria. They were at a place called 'Jarf' nearby Madinah when Prophet (PBUH) passed away. Now after Hazrat Abu Bakr took charge, majority of companions wanted that a big segment of Muslim army shouldn't be sent this much far away from Madinah at that time of crisis. But Hazrat Abu Bakr (RA) stood firm and said it was the order of Holy Prophet (PBUH) so it has to be fulfilled. Army marched to Syria and achieved its strategic goals.
- Some tribes had a misconception that Zakat was only supposed to be paid to Holy Prophet (PBUH) nobody else and they misunderstood Quranic verse:
 - ❖ "Take, [O, Muhammad], from their wealth a charity by which you purify them and cause them increase"

[09:103]

- Secondly these tribes thought that it can be collected and given to the local people without bringing it in central main stream. So, they refused to pay Zakat. Among these tribes there were: Abs, Zibyaan, Banu Kinana, Ghitfaan, Banu Fazaara, Banu Bakr and Banu Marrah. They sent a combined delegate but both parties couldn't accept each other terms. That delegate observed that regular Muslim army is absent. Hazrat Abu Bakr (RA) sensed their plan and imposed emergency in Madinah and ordered remaining army and volunteers to stay high alert. A failed attempt to attack Madinah was attempted by above mentioned tribes but Muslims defended Madinah and defeated them.
- People of Yemen, Bakhraan and Hadhramaut, Banu Tamim, Banu Hanifa, Muzir, Daus, Banu Aamir when got to know about Prophet's (PBUH) demise they forego Islam. Hazrat Abu Bakr (RA) took every necessary measure to call them back towards Islam or countering them with force if needed. But this movement was taken over by false Prophets as they both had the same enemy.
- The 1st false prophet was Aswad Ansi. He took over Yemen and overthrew Muslim government. He gathered huge support and controlled whole region of Yemen. Finally, he was executed by some Muslim assassins who killed him while he was drunk.
- Tulayha also declared himself prophet by claiming that Jibrail visits him and gathered support from Banu Tay, Ghitfan and Banu Asad. He was defeated by Khalid bin Waleed and Tulayha ran away and accepted Islam later.
- Sajjah bint e Harith also claimed prophethood and Banu Taghlib along with Banu Tamim and Banu Huzail (Christian Tribe) became his followers. She married with Musailmah so her movement was merged with Musailma.
- A man from Banu Hanifa Musailma was the strongest of them all. He met Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) in 9th AH and asked for caliphate which was refused. So, he himself announced his caliphate first and then became Prophet. He along with supporters of Sajjah emerged as the biggest threat for Islam. His power was crushed in battle of Yamamah and he was killed by Wahshi bin Harb (RA).
- The remaining apostate tribes were defeated at Bahrain, Amman, Mahrah, Yemen, Kandah and Hadhramaut.
- Hundreds of Huffaz got martyred in Battle of Yamamah. Umar (RA) persuaded Abu Bakr (RA) to compile Quran. He was hesitant at first but agreed later and appointed Zaid bin Thabit (RA) to do this honor. Zaid bin Thabit (RA) left no stone unturned and compiled an authentic and official copy of Quran. Therefore, Abu Bakr (RA) is called 'The Compiler of Quran'.
- Romans and Persians have been a constant threat for Islamic Caliphate since the era of Holy Prophet (PBUH). In 12th AH/633 AD Abu Bakr (RA) paid attention to these two rivals after achieving internal stability. He dispatched two armies to Iraq, 10 thousand Soldiers commanded by Khalid bin Walid (RA) other 8 thousand were led by Muthanna (RA). Then Khalid was given the supreme command he defeated Persians at Uballah, Zaat-ul-Salasil, Mazaar, Walajah, Ullis, Hairah, Anbaar, Ain-al-Tamar, Doma-tul-Jandal and Firaz.
- While Abu Bakr (RA) was busy in Ridda Wars and battles against false Prophets, Roman emperor ordered his armies to assemble at Islamic borders. Abu Bakr (RA) sent Khalid bin Saeed (RA) to border, ordered him not to engage just keep a hawk eye on roman developments. Then in 13th AH/634 AD He sent 5 armies commanded by Yazeed bin Abu Sufyan (RA), Abu Ubaidah bin Jarrah (RA), Amr bin Aas (RA), Shurahbil bin Hasanah and Ikrimah bin Abu Jahal (RA). Khalid bin Walid (RA) was also ordered to leave Iraq and reach Syria as soon as possible. Khalid Defeated Romans at Busrah and assembled all scattered Muslim armies at Ajnadayn. Khalid defeated 1 lac Roman warriors with his 40 thousand soldiers and forced Romans to retreat to Hims and Damascus.

Q (a) Describe Abu Bakr's activities against the false prophets and apostate tribes. [10]

Structure of Answer

Para 1:

- Apostate Tribes
- Battles at Bahrain, Amman, Mahrah, Yemen, Kandah and Hadhramaut.

Para 2:

- Aswad Ansi
- Tulayha Al-Asadi.

Para 3:

- Sajjah bint e Harith
- Musailmah the Liar
- Battle of Yamamah.

Answer

- After the conquest of Makkah whole Arabia was in awe of rise of Islam. So, majority of Arab tribes sent their delegates to offer their allegiance to Islam. That's why 9th year of Hijra is called the year of delegations. But not all of them were truly inspired by Islam. Some of them accepted it because of fear, some for power thirst and some for different social, territorial and economical relaxations.
- When they got to know about the demise of Holy Prophet (PBUH) they forego Islam and a huge apostasy movement was started. People of Yemen, Bakhraan and Hadhramaut, Banu Tamim, Banu Hanifa, Muzir, Daus, Banu Aamir. They became a huge threat to the survival of Islam as some of them tried to overthrow the Muslim governments and started plundering the masses. Hazrat Abu Bakr left no stone unturned to counter this threat. At first, he tried to solve this problem by calling them back to Islam. And he used force whenever needed.
- He defeated them at Bahrain, Amman, Mahrah, Yemen, Kandah and Hadhramaut. The remaining apostates joined false Prophets as both had a common enemy.
- The 1st ever person who claimed false prophet-hood was Aswad Al-Ansi, his name was Ab'hala bin Ka'ab and he belonged to the Maz'haj tribe. He was from Yemen and claimed Prophet-hood in the ending days of Holy Prophet (PBUH). He gathered a huge army and expelled the Muslim rulers of Yemen. A special task force consisting of Muslim assassins was given the task to assassinate him. They contacted some local lords who were also against Aswad even his wife also supported them and he was killed while he was drunk.
- Tulayha Al Asadi belonged to Banu Asad. He also declared himself as Prophet during last days of Prophet Muhammad (PBUH). A small fraction of Muslim Army was sent to encounter him, during fight he was hit by a Muslim soldier that was not on target. So, he started propagating his immortality. He claimed that Jibrail visits him and would recite fake revelations to impress his followers. An army commanded by Hazrat Khalid bin Waleed was sent to fight him. They somehow managed to contact 'Banu Tay' who were the major force of his army. Banu Tay joined Muslim army and Tulayha was defeated and ran away from the battle field. Later he accepted Islam.
- Sajjah bint e Harith also claimed prophethood and managed to get support from Banu Taghlib, Banu Tamim and Banu Huzail. Her followers were merged with the followers of Musailmah as she married him.
- Musailmah bin Habib who belonged to Banu Hanifa, was the strongest false Prophet Muslims faced. He along with his and Sajjah's followers became a huge threat for Islam. In 9th AH he first visited Holy Prophet (PBUH) and demanded his caliphate. Prophet (PBUH) refused but he went back and announced that he is

nominated caliph of Holy Prophet (PBUH). Later on, he claimed Prophethood. Hazrat Abu Bakr (RA) had to counter refusers of Zakat, Apostate tribes and false prophets so he distributed his army into 11 corps. He designated Ikrimah along with his corps to take position against Musailmah, but ordered him not to engage. Ikrimah could not wait and attacked Musailmah but was defeated by him. Hazrat Abu Bakr was pained and angered by this. Khalid bin Waleed (RA) then given the command along with a corps of Shurahbl (RA), he attacked Musailmah. This fierce battle is called the Battle of Yamamah. 40 thousand soldiers of Musailmah were ready to die for him that resulted in immense bloodshed from both sides. The final and fiercest phase of war fought in a garden, is called 'The Garden of Death'. The Musailmah was killed by Hazrat Wahshi bin Harb (RA). Hundreds of companions who memorized Quran got martyred but the apostasy movement along with the biggest false prophet got crushed.

(b) Explain why he was known as Siddique and the Savior of Islam. [4]

Answer

- Prophet (PBUH) himself stated that whenever I presented Islam to anyone he took some time to respond but Abu Bakr (RA) accepted it without taking a second.
- When Quraysh mocked Prophet (PBUH) on his claim of ascension because the claim was weak according to logic and common sense, Abu Bakr accepted it without any question of hesitation. He secured the title of Al-Siddique.
- When he became the Caliph, he had to face internal and external problems. He had to face apostasy movement, false prophets, refusers of Zakat and hypocrites. Along with external threats by Romans and Persians. But he did a great job and tackled them all very well. This made him the Savior of Islam.
- ❖ "If Allah (SWT) had not bestowed us with great leader like Abu Bakr (RA), we would have been vanished" Said Abdullah bin Masud (RA) [Futuh-ul-Buldan]

Q (b) The Prophet called Abu Bakr 'al-Siddiq' (Testifier of the Truth). How did Abu Bakr live up to his title during his caliphate? [04]

Answer

- Abu Bakr (RA) fought to uphold the finality of the Prophet (PBUH) in the wars against the false prophets. He crushed all four of them.
- He refused to give in to the demands of those who wanted to be exempted from paying zakat and fought battles with them. He demonstrated that truth must prevail and one should not give up when on right path.
- He preserved the word of God by having the Qur'an compiled as it was not compiled during the lifetime of Holy Prophet (PBUH). But when he saw memorizers dying one after another, He left no stone unturned and made an official copy of Quran so it can remain the guide for upcoming generations.